



PLAIN-LANGUAGE USER GUIDE

Hiring, made clear.

A simple guide to requesting a role, reviewing candidates, arranging interviews, and keeping recruitment moving.

Who is this for?

People who request new staff, HR teams, department heads, managers, recruiters, interviewers, and administrators.

START HERE

What this portal helps you do

The portal keeps the whole hiring request in one place. What you can see and change depends on your access, so some menu items may not appear for you.

1 Sign in and find your way around
Dashboard, menu, profile, and access

2 Request a new role
Staff addition or replacement

3 Review and approve requests
HR discusses and decides; management and department heads view only

4 Prepare a role for hiring
Screening and interview setup

5 Screen and manage applicants
Resumes, reviews, decisions, and notes

6 Ella Credits
Balance, manual credits, and payment

7 Arrange interviews
Available times, bookings, and attendance

8 For candidates
Apply and choose interview times

9 Help and good practice
Common problems and safe handling

The short version

Request the role → HR reviews the details and decides → HR prepares the hiring details → candidates are screened and interviewed.

About this pilot version

In the current pilot: HR has a company-wide view and makes all role and applicant decisions. Management has a company-wide **view-only** role — they can see everything but cannot approve, reject, send to manual review, change a role's status, edit recruitment setup, bulk screen, create invites or interview slots, or edit or delete applicants. Department Heads see only their own department's records, read-only. A role requester who has no reviewer access sees only their own requests and no applicant information. The bulk resume upload accepts up to **6** files per batch on the current Vercel Hobby deployment. Google Drive resume import is available; OneDrive import is built but stays hidden until a Microsoft administrator completes the Entra setup. Ella Credits include manual top-ups and HitPay sandbox purchases (see section 6). New-applicant notifications and the "Ella" in-portal help assistant are included (see sections 5 and 9).

Sign in and find your way around

Signing in

- 1 Open the McLink Recruitment Portal.**
Use the link provided by your organisation.
- 2 Choose “Sign in with Google”.**
Use your McLink Group Google Workspace account.
- 3 Start from the Dashboard.**
Your account permissions decide which areas are available.

If you cannot sign in

Make sure you are using your company account, not a personal Google account. If access is still denied, contact HR or the portal administrator.

The main menu

Menu item	What it is for
Dashboard	A quick view of hiring activity and the main steps in the process.
Role Requests	Create, find, filter, and follow staffing requests.
Resume Screening	For HR: upload several resumes and follow their progress.
Applicants	For reviewers: find candidates, read their information, and record decisions.
Bookings	For HR: view interview times and scheduled appointments.
Settings	View shared portal and calendar settings. Only authorised people can change them.
User Accounts	For administrators: add people and control what they can do.
Profile	View your name, department, and access.

Who does what?

The portal shows only the actions a person is allowed to use. The names below describe the usual responsibilities; one person may have more than one responsibility.

Requester

Creates a staffing request and follows the requests they submitted.

Usually sees: Dashboard, Role Requests, Profile.

HR or Recruiter

Reviews role details, prepares hiring information, screens candidates, arranges interviews, and manages the hiring list.

Usually sees: Role Requests, Resume Screening, Applicants, Bookings.

Department Head

Views requests and applicants for their own department only. Read-only — no approvals, edits, deletions, or applicant decisions.

Usually sees: their department's role requests and applicant records.

Management

Company-wide **view-only** access. Can open every role request and applicant record and read screening and interview information, but cannot approve, reject, send to manual review, change a role's status, edit recruitment setup, bulk screen, create invites or slots, or edit or delete applicants.

Usually sees: Role Requests, Applicants, Bookings — all read-only.

Interviewer

Reviews the information needed for interviews. Interview times and candidate links are provided by the portal.

Access may be limited to the information needed for the interview.

Administrator

Manages user access and, where authorised, shared settings and the interview calendar connection.

Give administrator access only to people who need it.

What you see may be different from a colleague

This is normal. If you need a menu item or action that is missing, ask HR or the portal administrator to review your access.

Create a new role request

Use a role request when your team needs an additional employee or needs to replace someone. Take a few minutes to gather the information before starting.

Before you begin

- ☐ Know the job title and department.
- ☐ Know whether this is a staff addition or a replacement.
- ☐ Have a clear description of the work and the reason for the request.
- ☐ Know the number of people needed and the target hiring date.
- ☐ Have the salary or budget information available if required by your process.

Steps

- 1 Open Role Requests, then select “Create Role Request”.**
- 2 Complete the role details.**

Enter the request type, department, employment type, job title, number of vacancies, and target hiring date.
- 3 Explain the need.**

For a replacement, name the employee or position being replaced. For any request, explain why the role is needed.
- 4 Add HR interview and screening questions if you have them.**

These questions help HR understand what to look for. They can be refined later.
- 5 Review and submit.**

The requester’s name and email are filled from the signed-in account. You cannot change those details in the form.

Tip: use the job description helper

If you have a job description file, upload it in the form or paste the description, then choose the option to fill in the form from it. Always check the suggested details before submitting.

What happens after submission?

The request is sent to HR for discussion. The requester can follow it from [Role Requests](#). A normal saved draft is not a submitted request and does not publish a job.

Review and approve a role request

Open a request from the Role Requests list to read the details, comments, history, and available actions. In the pilot, an HR reviewer both discusses and decides a role request directly from the HR discussion stage — there is no separate management-approval step. Management and Department Heads can open and read requests but cannot act on them.

Finding a request

- Use the **Status** filter to see requests at a particular step.
- Search by job title, role number, department, or requester.
- Use the sort options to find the newest request or the request with the nearest target date.
- Select **Refresh** if another person may have updated the request.

What the status means

Status	Plain meaning	Typical next step
Draft	Still being prepared.	Complete and submit it.
Pending HR Discussion	HR needs to review and decide the request.	HR checks the details, discusses any changes, then approves, returns for revision, places on hold, or rejects.
Returned for Revision	More information or changes are needed.	Requester or HR updates the request.
On Hold	The request is paused.	Resume it when the business is ready.
Approved	The role has approval to move forward.	HR completes the hiring setup.
Recruitment Setup	HR is preparing screening and interview details.	Complete the setup and publish when ready.
Job Posted	The role is available for candidates.	Review applicants as they arrive.
Rejected	The request will not move forward.	Read the comments for the reason.

Making a decision

An HR reviewer chooses the action that matches the decision, adds a clear comment when useful, and confirms. If the request has changed since you opened it, refresh the page and review it again before trying the action. If you are a Management or Department Head user, the decision actions are not shown — your view is read-only.

Remember

Approval of a role is not the same as publishing a job. HR still needs to complete the recruitment setup and publish the role.

Prepare an approved role for hiring

HR uses Recruitment Setup to tell the portal what to look for in resumes and interviews. This page is normally available only to HR reviewers.

Complete the screening instructions

- **What should the interviewer listen for?** Describe the evidence that matters for this role.
- **License or certificate:** State whether one is required, preferred, or not needed.
- **Keywords to look for:** Add useful skills, tools, or terms separated by commas.
- **Transferable skills accepted:** Explain what related experience may count.
- **Minimum relevant experience:** Use a simple requirement such as “None”, “3 years”, or “5+ years”.
- **Approved salary or budget range:** Enter the agreed range if applicable.
- **Earliest availability instructions:** Explain any start-date question to ask.

Set evaluation fields and questions

The portal always considers the candidate’s score, recommendation, strengths, and concerns. You can add role-specific items and up to three custom items. Add three to five interview questions. The questions are asked as written, so keep them clear and fair.

Suggested questions may be shown for review. Treat them as a starting point, edit them as needed, and make sure the final questions are relevant to the job.

Use the publishing checklist

- ☐ Choose at least one place where the job will be posted.
- ☐ Choose the salary visibility option.
- ☐ Choose the license requirement.
- ☐ Choose whether an HR interview is required.

Save and move the role forward

Button	Use it when
Save	You want to save changes and continue working.
Mark as Recruitment Ready	The basic screening and interview information is complete.
Mark as Ready for Publishing	The publishing checklist is complete and HR has reviewed it.
Publish Role	The role is ready to appear for candidates.

Good practice

Read the script preview before saving. It shows the kind of conversation candidates will receive and helps you catch unclear wording.

Screen and manage applicants

Open the applicant list

Choose **Applicants** to see the candidate list. Use the search box to find a candidate, role, email, or application number. Use the role and stage filters to narrow the list. Choose 10, 25, or 50 rows per page.

New-applicant notifications

A bell in the top bar shows how many applicants have applied since you last opened the Applicants page. HR sees new applicants company-wide; a Department Head sees only their own department's; Management sees the notifications but, like the rest of their access, cannot act on the records; a plain requester has no bell. Opening the bell lists the new candidates and links straight to each record. Opening the Applicants page clears the count; a candidate who applies after that appears as new again.

Pilot limitation: the "last seen" mark is stored in your browser, so the new/seen state is per browser and per device and does not follow you between devices.

Understand the summary cards

Applications

Total applications in the available history.

Resume Screened

Applications that have been processed and are ready for review.

Voice Interview

Candidates with activity in the phone interview stage.

HR Interview

Candidates who have moved beyond the phone interview stage.

Read an applicant record

Select **View** beside a candidate. The record brings together contact information, role, resume information, screening result, interview activity, and history. Use the linked resume only for recruitment purposes.

Send a personal application link

HR can invite one person to apply for one published role. The link opens the familiar candidate application page with the role and invited person's details already prepared.

1 Open **Resume Screening**.

2 Choose the published role.

Only roles that are ready to accept applications can be selected.

3 Enter the candidate's name and email address.

Check the spelling carefully before continuing.

4 Select "Generate application link", then copy it.

Send the link privately to the intended candidate.

5 Check Applicants after the candidate submits.

The link is for one successful application only. If it expires or has already been used, generate a new one.

Keep invitation links private

The link is tied to the selected role and invited candidate. Do not post it in a group chat or send it to someone else.

Common applicant stages

Stage	What it means
Resume HR Review	The resume has been received and needs a human review.
Resume Approved	The candidate can move to the phone interview step.
Voice Booking Pending	The candidate needs to choose a phone interview time.
Voice Interview Scheduled	A phone interview time has been booked.
Voice HR Review	The phone interview result is ready for HR to review.
Approved for Face-to-Face Interview	The candidate can choose a Face-to-Face Interview time.
Face-to-Face Interview Scheduled	A Face-to-Face Interview time has been booked.
Passed Face-to-Face Interview	The candidate passed the Face-to-Face Interview step.
Rejected	The candidate will not move to the next step.

Deleting a record is permanent

Deleting an applicant also removes related screening information, history, and interview times. Check carefully before confirming.

Upload several resumes at once

HR can screen a group of resumes for one published role from **Resume Screening**. Each file is handled once for that role, and progress appears on the page.

Upload from your computer

- 1 Choose the published role.**
Pick the role that matches every resume in this batch.
- 2 Add the files.**
Drag them into the box or click the box to choose them. PDF, DOC, and DOCX files are accepted. You can add up to 6 files per batch in the pilot, with a 10 MB limit per file. Each resume that screens successfully uses one Ella Credit; files that are skipped as duplicates or that fail are not charged.
- 3 Select “Start screening”.**
The portal sends the resumes for processing and shows each one in the queue.
- 4 Watch the progress.**
The list updates automatically. You can also choose “Refresh status”.
- 5 Review the applicants.**
When processing is complete, choose “View Processed Applicants” to begin the human review.

Import from Google Drive

Choose the published role first. The first time you use this, select **Connect Google Drive** and sign in with your McLink Group Google account (HR only). After that, select **Choose from Google Drive**, browse to the folder holding the resumes, tick the files you want (PDF, DOC, or DOCX; up to 6 per import), and confirm. Imported resumes go through exactly the same screening pipeline, duplicate check, and one-credit-per-successful-file rule as a computer upload. A resume already screened for this role is skipped and not charged.

Import from OneDrive

OneDrive import works exactly like Google Drive import — same 6-file limit, 10 MB per file, accepted file types, duplicate check, and one-credit-per-successful-file rule. Select **Connect OneDrive** and sign in with your Microsoft 365 account (HR only), then **Choose from OneDrive**. **Pending setup** A Microsoft administrator must first register the portal in Microsoft Entra; until that is done the OneDrive buttons stay hidden. See *OneDrive resume import — Microsoft Entra setup* for the administrator steps.

Queue messages

Message	What to do
Queued	Wait. The file has been accepted and is waiting to be processed.
Processing	Wait. The portal is reading and checking the resume.
Completed / Screened	Open the applicant list and review the candidate.
Skipped	The file was already handled for this role.
Failed	Check the file and choose "Retry failed". Use a readable, unlocked PDF, DOC, or DOCX.

Important

Automatic screening is an aid for HR, not a final hiring decision. Always review the resume and supporting information yourself.

Credits, balance, and payment

Ella Credits meter the AI features. One AI CV analysis costs **1 credit**; one AI phone interview costs **10 credits**. The balance is shared for the whole organisation and is shown on [Settings > Ella Credits](#). Skipped duplicates and files that fail before analysis are not charged, and the same billable action is never charged twice.

Who can manage credits

Role	View balance & ledger, add manual credits, buy credits
Admin / IT Admin	Allowed
HR	Allowed
Management	Not allowed
HOD / Department Head	Not allowed
Requester / Employee	Not allowed

Add credits manually (demo / adjustment)

On [Settings > Ella Credits](#), enter a **positive whole number** and a **reason** (required), and optionally a reference. The adjustment is written to the credit ledger with your name, the amount, the reason, the reference, the time, and the resulting balance. The balance can never be changed without a ledger entry, and re-submitting the same adjustment does not add the credits twice.

Buy credits (HitPay)

- 1 Choose a credit pack.**
The price is set by the portal — you only choose a pack, never a price or a credit amount.
- 2 Pay on the HitPay page.**
You are taken to HitPay to complete payment, then returned to the portal.
- 3 Wait for confirmation.**
Credits are added only after HitPay confirms the payment to the portal directly — returning to the page is not enough on its own. This usually takes a few seconds.

Pilot

Payments in the pilot run against the HitPay **sandbox** — no real money moves. This feature is inactive until the payment keys are configured for the pilot deployment; until then the “Buy credits” action reports that it is not set up yet.

Payment statuses

Status	Meaning
Pending	Payment started, not yet confirmed. No credits added yet.
Paid	Confirmed by HitPay. Credits have been added to the balance.
Failed	Payment did not complete. No credits added.
Expired / Cancelled	The payment link lapsed or was cancelled. No credits added.

When the balance is too low

An AI action that the balance cannot cover is refused before any work is done, with a message showing how many credits are needed and how many remain. Top up (manually or by purchase) and try again. Existing screening and interview results are never lost.

Arrange and follow interviews

View the interview calendar

HR can open **Bookings** to see monthly availability and appointments. Use the role and interview-type filters to focus the view. Choose a date to see open times, scheduled candidates, completed interviews, and conflicts.

Add HR availability

1. Choose **+ HR Availability**.
2. Choose an approved role.
3. Choose **Refresh availability** to check the shared HR calendar.
4. Ask the candidate to use the booking link they received.

The candidate sees individual available times. They do not see the full internal calendar.

When a candidate books

The selected time becomes a scheduled appointment, the candidate receives a confirmation, and the calendar is updated. The portal also records the time zone so the candidate and HR see the same appointment time.

If a candidate does not attend

Open the date details, find the scheduled appointment, and choose **Mark No Show** after the interview time has started. Confirm the action. This keeps the attendance record clear and allows the team to decide whether to offer another time.

Calendar connection

Interview availability comes from the shared HR calendar. If it is not connected, ask the person who manages Settings to reconnect or check the calendar.

Phone (voice) interview

When HR approves a candidate at the resume stage, the candidate is invited to book a phone interview and is called automatically at the booked time. The result and a transcript return to the applicant record, with each answer shown under the question it belongs to. Calls that come back as No Answer, Busy, or Wrong Person, and no-shows, are handled through the retry and no-show lifecycle rather than counting as a completed interview.

Face-to-face interview

After HR approves a candidate at the phone-interview stage, the candidate books a face-to-face interview against the shared HR calendar, which blocks times that conflict with existing calendar events. The candidate is added as an attendee on the calendar event, and the **venue or address** HR enters is included in the invitation and shown on the completed booking in the portal.

For candidates: applying and booking

Apply for a role

1 Open the job application page.

For a personal invitation, open the link sent by HR. The role and your name may already be filled in.

2 Enter your details.

Provide your name, email address, country, and mobile number.

3 Attach your resume.

Use a readable PDF, DOC, or DOCX file and check that the file is the correct version.

4 Review the privacy and consent message.

Continue only when you understand and agree to the stated use of your information.

5 Submit the application once.

A confirmation message means the application was received. Sending it again may create another application.

Book a phone interview

Open the private booking link in the invitation email. Enter your local mobile number without the country code, choose a date, choose a time, and confirm. Keep the confirmation email.

Book an HR interview

If HR invites you to the next step, open the new booking link and choose from the available times. The page shows whether the interview is scheduled, completed, or no longer available.

Keep booking links private

These links are personal. Do not forward them to another person or post them in a group chat. If the link does not work, contact the recruitment team and ask for a new invitation.

Common questions

“I cannot see a role or applicant.”

Your access may limit you to your own requests or your department. Ask HR to confirm that you have the right access.

“My request is not moving.”

Check the status and latest comment on the request. It may be waiting for HR to review, returned for more information, or on hold.

Ask Ella (in-portal help)

The portal includes a help assistant called **Ella** for common questions about how the portal works. Open it from the help button and type your question. It only explains features and steps — it does not make hiring decisions or change any records — and you should not enter candidate personal data or passwords into it. During the pilot the assistant may still be in setup and reply that it "is currently being configured"; until then, contact HR or the portal administrator for help.

“The role was approved but candidates cannot apply.”

Approval is only one step. HR must complete the Recruitment Setup checklist and publish the role.

“A resume failed.”

Make sure it is a readable, unlocked PDF, DOC, or DOCX file and no larger than 10 MB. Try the retry option. If it still fails, ask HR to check the file or enter the candidate another way. A failed file is not charged an Ella Credit.

“There are not enough Ella Credits.”

The AI action is refused before any work is done — nothing is lost. An Admin or HR user can add credits on [Settings > Ella Credits](#) (a manual top-up, or a purchase). See section 6.

“I paid but the credits are not showing.”

Credits are added only when the payment provider confirms the payment to the portal directly, which is usually seconds but can lag. If it has not appeared after a few minutes, an Admin or HR user can open the payment on the Ella Credits page and choose to re-check its status.

“The calendar shows no times.”

Check the role and interview-type filters, choose the correct month, and refresh. If there are still no times, ask the calendar administrator to check the shared HR calendar.

“The page says someone else changed the record.”

Refresh the page, read the latest information, and then try again. This prevents one person's changes from replacing another person's work.

Good practice

Do

- Use clear, job-related information.
- Check details before submitting or publishing.
- Keep candidate information private.
- Use human judgment alongside screening results.
- Add useful comments when returning or rejecting a request.

Do not

- Share private booking links.
- Use personal accounts for company recruitment work.
- Make a hiring decision based only on an automated score.
- Upload a resume to the wrong role.
- Delete records unless you are sure they should be removed.

Need more help?

Take a screenshot of the message, note the role or application number, and contact HR or the portal administrator. Do not include passwords or private booking links.

This guide describes the McLink Recruitment Portal interface and usual hiring process. Your organisation's access rules and hiring policies always take priority.